

Ukraine faces compounding human capital pressures: 14.6M people need aid, 4M remain displaced abroad, yet 10M+ IDPs returned home in 2025 signaling recovery momentum. The tech sector retains 285K IT professionals, while new IDP strategy and \$2.5B displacement funding create structural opportunities for talent reintegration.

IOM reports 10M+ IDP returns in 2025 — the highest ever — coinciding with Ukraine's new 5-year displacement strategy, creating a critical policy window to convert returnee momentum into structured human capital recovery.

RETURN

Record 10M IDP Returns Signal Recovery Momentum

IOM reports over 10 million IDPs returned home in 2025, the highest annual figure recorded. \$2.5B has been unlocked globally for displacement solutions, providing fiscal infrastructure to support sustainable return programs in Ukraine.

3R: Largest return signal in the conflict period; funding availability makes this the optimal moment to build structured diaspora and IDP reactivation pipelines.

IOM

UNHCR: New 5-Year State Strategy on Internal Displacement

Ukraine's Cabinet of Ministers adopted a new five-year State Strategy on Internal Displacement on June 10, 2026. UNHCR's policy brief outlines frameworks for durable solutions, creating an official policy anchor for return and reintegration initiatives.

3R: Official 5-year strategy provides legal and institutional framework to align diaspora reactivation programs with state policy, enabling scalable return initiatives.

UNHCR / RELIEFWEB

UNHCR Refugee Intentions Survey: Perspectives on Return

UNHCR's sixth wave of 'Lives on Hold' survey captures return intentions of Ukrainian refugees, returnees, and IDPs. Data reveals nuanced barriers and motivators for repatriation critical for designing effective diaspora reactivation policies.

3R: Real-time intention data is essential intelligence for calibrating return incentive programs and identifying which diaspora segments are closest to reactivation.

UNHCR OPERATIONAL DATA PORTAL

Women Must Lead Ukraine's Reconstruction — Recovery Conference

At the Ukraine Recovery Conference, advocates stressed that women must be central to reconstruction decision-making. Gender-inclusive recovery frameworks are essential for reactivating the significant female portion of the Ukrainian diaspora.

3R: Majority of Ukrainian diaspora in Europe is female; gender-responsive return policies directly determine the scale of diaspora reactivation success.

INSTAGRAM / UKRAINE RECOVERY CONFERENCE

RECRUIT

Ukraine Retains 285K IT Professionals Amid Conflict

Despite disruptions, Ukraine maintains approximately 285,000 IT professionals distributed across the country and abroad. Engineering leaders increasingly build core teams in Poland and Ukraine, signaling continued global demand for Ukrainian tech talent.

3R: 285K active IT professionals represent a recruitable diaspora-adjacent talent pool; nearshore demand from EU firms creates leverage for structured skill-gap recruitment partnerships.

ENGIPULSE

Ukrainian Refugees Fill EU Labor Market Gaps Short-Term

VoxUkraine's Europe 2050 analysis shows Ukrainian refugees contributing to EU labor markets in sectors with acute worker shortages. This dual dynamic — filling EU gaps while creating gaps at home — defines the core recruit challenge for Ukraine's recovery.

3R: Understanding where Ukrainians are employed in Europe enables targeted recruitment campaigns to channel diaspora skills toward Ukraine's own reconstruction skill gaps.

VOXUKRAINE

RETAIN

Social Cohesion as Foundation for Retaining IDPs and Returnees

IOM's DTM report on social cohesion in Ukraine finds that recovery depends on community integration of arrivals and returnees. Poor social cohesion drives secondary displacement and talent flight, undermining retention of skilled workers in host communities.

3R: Social cohesion is a direct retention lever; communities that successfully integrate IDPs retain more human capital and reduce brain drain to safer regions or abroad.

IOM DISPLACEMENT TRACKING MATRIX

Ongoing Attacks Accelerate Brain Drain Risk

ICRC reports widespread attacks on Kyiv on July 1, 2026, with 14.6M people needing aid and 4M Ukrainians displaced abroad. Continued insecurity is the primary driver of talent emigration and the central barrier to retention of skilled professionals.

3R: Security conditions directly correlate with skilled worker retention decisions; each major attack event triggers measurable emigration spikes among high-skill demographics.

ICRC / FACEBOOK

GLOBAL CONTEXT

Humanitarian Crisis in Russian-Occupied Southern Ukraine

Atlantic Council documents severe humanitarian conditions in Russian-occupied southern Ukraine, with thousands facing serious threats. Occupied territories represent a frozen human capital loss that cannot be addressed through standard 3R interventions until liberation.

3R: Occupied territory populations represent a latent human capital reserve requiring pre-planned reintegration frameworks for eventual return, recruitment, and retention post-liberation.

ATLANTIC COUNCIL

OECD: Non-Compete Clauses Risk Constraining Talent Mobility

OECD's 2026 report on non-compete clause regulation across member countries highlights how restrictive clauses can limit worker mobility. For Ukrainian professionals in EU labor markets, overly broad non-competes could hinder repatriation or cross-border recruitment.

3R: Policy context: EU labor market regulations including non-competes shape the practical feasibility of recruiting Ukrainian diaspora professionals back to home-country roles.

OECD
